critically reviewed by serious scholars in Poland. Chodakiewicz and like-minded authors are reluctant to accept the idea that Poles were responsible for bloody postwar pogroms in Kielce and elsewhere, and other cases in which Jews were killed. They seek to "contextualize," if not to justify, such actions in terms of a payback for the purported crimes suffered by Poles at the hands of Jewish Stalinists.

Of course, there is nothing very new in this approach. Its precursors can be found in the crude, pseudo-scholarly screeds of those associated with the Grunwald group that emerged in Poland in the 1980s as well as other elements within the Communist party, and among its fellow travelers, including the Pax organization led by Bołeslaw Piasecki. Chodakiewicz, however, took this defense strategy to a new and altogether dizzying level. In addition to advancing the thesis that there was some sort of symmetry between Poles who killed Jews and Jewish-born Communist partisans and functionaries who killed Poles, he suggested that:

> For several hundred years now, secular utopians have been bludgeoning traditional foundations of the Western civilization. Lately, the "progressives" have focused on Poland as a substitute target for a larger assault on traditional American values. They have blamed Poland for antisemitism, including an alleged complicity in the Holocaust. This has succeeded because the secularists command the symbols and language of America's discourse.[18]

In other words, according to Chodakiewicz, one could infer that those who study the history of antisemitism in Poland, including the role of locals in the destruction of Jewish communities, are really advancing an agenda at the core of which lies the ultimate downfall of the United States and Western civilization.

Among the other neo-Endek researchers is Piotr Gontarczyk, who is associated with the IPN and is the author of several tracts on Polish-Jewish relations that were roundly criticized by mainstream Polish historians. Another is Peter D. Stachura, an historian at the University of Stirling, who has bristled vituperatively at the suggestion that Polish society played an unsavory role in the despoliation and dispatch of Polish Jews. The Jewish background of some of the historians working on this subject, he suggested, cast suspicion on the merits of their scholarship, and especially their critique of Chodakiewicz.

Perhaps the most dramatic case was that of Krzysztof Jasiewicz, a well-known and once well-respected scholar associated with the Polish Academy of Science, who declared in an interview in a special issue of the popular

Copyright © 2016. Nebraska. All rights reserved.

Anti-Judaism, Antisemitism, and Delegitimizing Israel, Nebraska, 2016. ProQuest Ebook Central,